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Forward Deployed Software Engineer II (Ref: 24211)

HM Courts and Tribunals Service

Apply before 11:55 pm on Friday 27th November 2026

HM Courts & Tribunals Service

Reference number

490766

Salary

£58,511 - £70,725

The national salary is £58,511 - £65,329. London salary is £63,343 - £70,725. Your salary will be dependent on your base location

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

MOJ Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Operational Delivery

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time

Number of jobs available

2

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Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, Scotland, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This is a Nationally based role

Job description

HM Courts and Tribunals Service

Job Title: Forward Deployed Software Engineer II

Grade: G7

Directorate: CEO Office

Location: London / National

Contract Type: Permanent

Working Pattern: Full-time/ Flexible Working

This is a full-time position only due to the nature of the role.

Successful applicants will be expected to be office based 3 days per week in any HMCTS Office (subject to business availability).

Level of Clearance: To apply for this role, you will be required to successfully complete Counter Terrorism Check (CTC level as a condition of appointment. For further guidance click here

Introduction

HM Courts & Tribunals Service (HMCTS) is responsible for the administration of criminal, civil and family courts and tribunals in England and Wales. Our roles support our service users and colleagues, where people and businesses access potentially life-changing justice. We re looking for individuals who are committed to public service and want to make a difference in people s lives in delivering justice. If you re interested in developing a career with a real purpose, please apply.

Job Description

Courts AI is a small, hands-on engineering team inside HMCTS. We build and ship software that makes the courts work better: for the judiciary, for court staff, and for the people who come before them. We are an engineering team with exceptional direct links to users and real problems, and a mandate to do

something about them. We value engineering excellence, high agency and empathy.

We work closely with court staff, digital teams and the judiciary to develop practical solutions that improve how courts operate.

Y**our role as Forward Deployed Software Engineer II will encompass several key responsibilities listed below (but not limited to):**

Key Responsibilities

You will work as an engineer on projects under the direction of a technical lead, helping ship new capability to users.

You will contribute across the stack, from infrastructure and backend services to data, integrations and user-facing interfaces, with guidance from the G6 and wider team. The role is hands on, with room to take ownership of defined pieces of work, learn quickly, and help discover the next set of problems to pursue. Concretely this means:

Build and improve products used across the HMCTS estate web services, integrations, data tooling, and where it genuinely helps, models and agents.

Work in the field. You'll spend real time in courts and with operational teams, watching how work actually happens, and co-designing with the people doing it.

Support across delivery from ideation of the problem, through building and deploying it, to supporting adoption and keeping it alive. You will take ownership of outcomes.

Make the case with evidence. Measuring whether a thing worked, and being honest when it didn't, is part of the job.

Public service motivated. The work is genuinely consequential, with opportunities to make a tangible difference to how justice is delivered. You'll be motivated by solving difficult problems and delivering better outcomes for the people who rely on our courts.

Technically strong. We are building parts of the future government software stack. This is in flux, and needs solid technical skills, curiosity, and a willingness to learn how we can move rapidly and safely.

Pragmatists. You are able to identify viable paths forward that enable us to ship today.

High agency and comfort in ambiguity. The problem space can be open ended, and needs exploration. You're comfortable asking good questions, trying things out, and making progress with support from others.

Bridge-builders. You will work with a wide variety of stakeholders, with different needs and levels of technical confidence. You can take part in a technical design conversation and a conversation with a court clerk on the same afternoon, and take both seriously.

You do not need to meet every point below. If you're strong across most of it and can learn quickly, we'd like to hear from you.

Essential skills:

Experience building software in production.

Willingness to work across different parts of the stack, from infrastructure-as-code to user-facing interfaces, with support where needed.

Some experience, or clear interest, in integrating with systems you do not control, including older ones.

Ability to work constructively in a complex organisation collaborating, building relationships, and helping move work forward.

Developing judgement about where AI genuinely helps, and where it may add risk without adding value.

The below criteria are desirable only. These will not be assessed throughout the recruitment process but will be used in the event of tied scores between candidates.

Desirable Criteria

Cloud and infrastructure experience Azure, Kubernetes/AKS, Terraform.

Exposure to LLM-based systems, including evaluation, observability or production deployment.

Data engineering, or making messy operational data useful.

Startup, scale-up, product engineering, or other delivery-focused environments.

Prior public sector delivery helpful but not required. We ll help you navigate the system

Application process:

This role will be recruited using a combination of Government Digital and Data (GDD) Profession Capability Framework and Success Profiles Frameworks during the sift and interview process. Using GDD we will then determine if you will be paid an additional allowance, on top of your basic salary. This role is within the Technical job family and is a Software Developer role at Lead Developer level but carries the title, Forward Deployed Software Engineer in the CEO office.

Stage 1 - Sift:

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application:

An **anonymised CV**, setting out your career history, key responsibilities and achievements. Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Essential Skills section of this advert.

A **Statement of Suitability** which should give us real life examples of how your skills and experience match those needed for this role. We recommend following the **STAR** format.

Should we receive a high volume of applications, a pre-sift may be conducted on the **CV.** Candidates who pass the pre-sift will be fully assessed on all the sift criteria.

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - Application Guidance

Successful candidates who passed the sift will be invited to a first stage interview via Microsoft Teams.

Stage 2 - First Stage Interview:

First stage interview will be held via MS Team. At the first interview stage you will be assessed against a **Technical Assessment.**

For further guidance on the interview process please click here

Successful candidate who meet the required standard will be invited to a second interview assessment in line with the Civil Service Success Profile Framework and the Government Communications Service (GCS) competencies. Interviews will take place over two stages.

Stage 2 Second Stage Interview:

Second stage interview will be held via MS Team. At interview stage, you will be assessed against **Technical, Strengths and Behaviours.**

Making Effective Decisions

Communicating and Influencing

Working Together

Delivering at Pace

Level of Clearance

To apply for this role, you will be required to successfully complete Counter Terrorism Check (CTC level as a condition of appointment. To meet these requirements, you will normally need to have been resident in the UK for at least 3 years. For further information please click here

Salary details

New recruits to the Civil Service joining MoJ are expected to join at the band minimum.

Existing Civil Servants applying on promotion, will usually be appointed on the salary minimum of the new pay band, or receive an increase of 10 percent on the current base salary, whichever is higher (This is restricted to the pay maximum of the new band).

Travel requirements

There will be a requirement to travel frequently to any HMCTS site in line with business needs.

Proud to Serve. Proud to keep justice going.

Person specification

Please refer to the Job Description

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

- Making Effective Decisions
- Communicating and Influencing
- Working Together
- Delivering at Pace

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

- Capability Skill 1: Programming and build (software engineering)
- Capability Skill 2: Systems design
- Capability Skill 3: Systems integration
- Capability Skill 4: User focus

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £58,511, HM Courts and Tribunals Service contributes £16,950 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

- Access to learning and development
- A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance
- A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity
- A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%
- Annual Leave
- Public Holidays

Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using Success Profiles (opens in a new window), and will assess your Behaviours, Strengths, Experience and Technical skills.

https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is counter-terrorist check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone :	0345 241 5359
Recruitment team	
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission s Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (Moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the

Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints/

https://jobs.justice.gov.uk/careers/JobDetail/24211?entityId=24211

Civil Service Commission